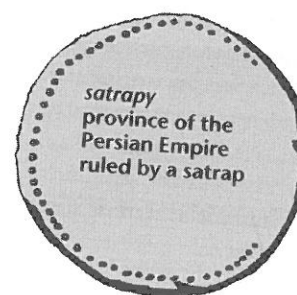


Administration of the empire

Once Alexander had conquered the Persian Empire he was faced with the problem of administering and keeping it. The Persian Empire was multi-racial with a number of different political and religious systems. It was large and geographically diverse.

The Persian kings had divided their empire into twenty satrapies (provinces), governed by appointed satraps (governors). Alexander's solutions to the problem of how to administer the empire show him at his best: creative, adaptable and diplomatic. He attempted to win over the locals in the different areas by tolerating their cultures and using existing forms of government where possible.

strictly under any governor's control, although they did have to do whatever Alexander asked and accept a Macedonian garrison. Most also paid a levy, the *syntaxis*, for the campaign. Important matters, such as foreign affairs, also had to be discussed with Alexander. Just how far the Greek city states' freedom extended in reality can be seen in the example of Aspendus (Arrian, 8.26-27).



Administration at home

In the Balkans, Alexander was the king of Macedonia and Strategos Autokrator of the League of Corinth's forces. He was also unofficially hegemon. Antipater acted as regent in Alexander's absence. With a strong Macedonian army and the loyalty of several smaller Greek states, Antipater was able to control the area until after Alexander's death. A revolt led by King Agis of Sparta in 331BC was quickly put down. Members of the League contributed money, men, supplies and ships to Alexander's campaigns but maintained control of their own affairs. As such they had to be asked or consulted on key issues within Greece.

Given that Alexander's original intention was the 'liberation' of the Greeks in Asia Minor, he was forced to treat these peoples differently from the 'barbarians' he conquered. The Greek city states on the Asian coastline usually had democracies set up in them. This happened for political reasons, because democracies tended to be anti-Persian. The cities paid no tribute to Alexander, were allowed to run their own affairs and were not

Collecting tribute

Aspendus had submitted freely but Alexander, short of money and supplies, ordered the people to pay 50 talents in cash and to supply horses to the army just as they had done for Darius. They refused. Alexander besieged the town, captured it, doubled the *syntaxis* and subjected the city to paying an annual tribute to Macedonia and to the satrap. Hostages were taken and some land was given to neighbouring cities. Whether these Greek cities became members of the League of Corinth is uncertain.

Finance officers, such as Coeranus of Beroea (Phoenicia) and Philoxenus (Asia, this side of the Taurus), were appointed (Arrian, 3.6). Their power extended over several satrapies. They collected taxes and transferred the money raised to the royal treasury in Babylon. These new officers replaced the satraps who normally did this job under the Persians.

After the capture of Ecbatana (330BC) and the end of the joint league action, contributions of the Greeks in Asia Minor may have stopped. Alexander had captured the Persian treasures and probably no longer needed these 'contributions'.

